

TRAVEL DIARY

SRI LANKA & MALDIVES (SMS)

Last updated: 8 July 2026

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https://www.google.com/maps/d/u/0/edit?mid=1fcqcRu80vtCcQBRbxvg-xd2WbRG9m_c&usp=sharing

[JOIN THE TELEGRAM GROUP HERE](#)

TOUR LEADER FLIGHT BUDGET - COMPULSORY

Max budget for the TL flights: **1000 EUR** (July: **1100 EUR** - August and December: **1300 EUR**)

If you are over budget, email vale.id@gmail.com BEFORE booking to get approval.

Before purchasing flights, tour leaders must wait until the tour has at least 3 confirmed participants. If the tour departs in less than 3 months, they must wait until there are at least 4 confirmed participants.

FLIGHT BOOKING CONFIRMATION – COMPULSORY

Once you have completed your flight purchase on BizAway, you are **required** to send a confirmation email to **vale.id@gmail.com**.

The subject line and body format below must be followed exactly — an automated script reads these emails, and any change to the format or subject line will cause the extraction to fail.

Subject:

Flight Booked - [Tour Code]

Tour Leader: _____

Tour Code: _____

BizAway Code: _____

Amount Spent: € _____

Example:

Subject:

Flight Booked - IT-WX-EAZ-OPC-BL-AY-20260913-A

Tour Leader: Valentina Idrofano

Tour Code: IT-WX-EAZ-OPC-BL-AY-20260913-A

BizAway Code: GTHZAIR9JM

Amount Spent: € 1279.00

ADDITIONAL NIGHT REQUEST FORM - MANDATORY

This form must always be completed to request an additional night before departure. An additional night is approved **ONLY** if the TL is forced to arrive the day before in order to stay within the compulsory flight budget above.

If your flight lands at, say, 2:00 AM on the departure day itself, **no additional night will be granted**: you will simply be welcomed at the hotel reception and can use the hotel services and pool while waiting for the regular check-in time.

How to submit: copy/paste the table below, fill it in, and send it via email to vale.id@gmail.com together with your flight confirmation.

Email subject must be: [Tour code] - [Requester's name]

Tour Leader name	
Tour code / date	
Flight arrival date & time (local)	
Reason: forced to arrive early to stay within the flight budget? (YES/NO)	

Additional night requested for date	
Coordinator approval & date	

LOCAL PARTNER: all the tours will be managed by a local partner: **WanderlustAsia**

info@wanderlust-asia.com

+94 77 706 7295 (please contact them just in case you need real assistance! For all the other requests and infos send an email to vale.id@gmail.com)

You can get in contact with the local partner (WanderlustAsia) only for relevant matters such as:

- Errors on the vouchers
- Any emergency or problem related to the services provided by them
- to set up a first briefing meeting at the first hotel lobby in Negombo

→ **DO NOT GET IN CONTACT WITH THE PARTNER EARLIER THAN 3 DAYS BEFORE DEPARTURE**

→ **DO NOT CONTACT THE PARTNER FOR GENERAL QUESTIONS ABOUT THE DESTINATION OR TO ASK CHANGES IN THE SERVICES AGREED BETWEEN THE PARTNER AND THE TRAVEL PRODUCER**

VOUCHER

You will have a voucher with the recap of services (you can find it in your coordinator personal area 3 days before departure).

The extra activities or excursions can be added on the spot, just ask to your driver and co-driver

QUICK CONTACTS SUMMARY

Contact	Details	Notes
Wanderlust Asia – Local Partner (Sri Lanka)	+94 77 706 7295 / info@wanderlust-asia.com	Only for voucher errors, emergencies, or first briefing setup
Maldives Fellas – Giorgia Atripaldi	+39 339 6351542	WeRoad TL living in Maldives; contact at least 15 days before arrival
ShadowPalm (Maafushi excursions)	shadowpalm@maafushi.com / WhatsApp +960 9960109	Reliable operator for WE/DE groups; euro cash accepted
Alba (Maafushi excursions)	+39 340 864 7210	Italian-speaking, can arrange excursions directly
Triton Hotel – Hotel Manager Malithi	+960 7629991	Assistance for excursions/general info if staying at Triton
Icom Tours / Maafushi Tours (speedboat)	https://icomtours.com/	Return speedboat Maafushi to Male, book 3-4 days in advance

MONEY POT

- Eur 200 (more than enough) for the Sri Lankan part of the itinerary.. In the Maldives all the excursions must be considered optional and up to the customers

IMPORTANT NOTE FOR WE COUNTRY COORDINATORS — VALID ONLY FOR WE DEPARTURES



In WE the concept of the "common fund" no longer applies to optional activities. Coordinators must **NOT collect money from the group at the start of the trip** for these optional activities. Instead, the coordinator should collect sign-ups from participants for each optional activity, and only charge/collect payment from the pax who confirm they want to join. The tour leader personally decides whether or not to join an optional activity, and if they do, it is at their own expense.

WE optional activities and approx. prices (Sri Lanka):

- Entrance fee to the UNESCO site of Anuradhapura — approx. USD 25
- Entrance fee to the UNESCO site of Sigiriya — approx. USD 30
- Safari to Minneriya National Park with jeep and driver — approx. USD 50
- Entrance to the Dambulla caves — approx. USD 10
- Entrance to the Temple of the Tooth in Kandy — approx. USD 10
- Tips

Please note: all activities and excursions in the Maldives are optional and at the participant's expense. In the day-by-day itinerary you will find the description of some activities with their relative price range.

Reminder: this rule applies ONLY to WE country departures.

TOTAL AVERAGE EXPENSES

- Average on top of the money pot: 200€ (most common items: food, drinks, water, souvenirs, massages)
- Average cost of lunch/dinner: 7/10 euros

TO DO before departure

- **SRI LANKA VISA:** You need to complete the [ETA](#) visa application online. The process is very simple, and you usually receive your visa within about 24 hours. **NEWS: starting from 25/5/2026 the VISA will be free if you're from Italy, UK, Germany and Spain but you still need to apply!** Don't worry if you don't receive a confirmation email right away: just save your **application number**, go back to the official website, and check your application status. You don't need to print anything — it's an electronic visa, so they only need to see your passport.
- **Important:** make sure to use **only the official website**. Any other site will definitely charge you more!

Alert 01 (Effective from 25.05.2026)

1. With effect from 25.05.2026, nationals of the following 40 countries are eligible to obtain tourist visa (ETA) free-of-charge for a period of 30 days.

1. AUSTRALIA	11. FRANCE	21. MALAYSIA	31. SAUDI ARABIA
2. AUSTRIA	12. GERMANY	22. NEPAL	32. SOUTH KOREA
3. BAHARAIN	13. INDIA	23. NETHERLAND	33. SPAIN
4. BELARUS	14. INDONESIA	24. NEW ZEALAND	34. SWEDEN
5. BELGIUM	15. IRAN	25. NORWAY	35. SWITZERLAND
6. CANADA	16. ISRAEL	26. OMAN	36. THAILAND
7. CHINA	17. ITALY	27. PAKISTAN	37. TURKEY
8. CZECH REPUBLIC	18. JAPAN	28. POLAND	38. UAE
9. DENMARK	19. KAZAKHSTAN	29. QATAR	39. UNITED KINGDOM
10. FINLAND	20. KUWAIT	30. RUSSIA	40. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

- No visa for Maldives: you just need to fill in an arrival and departure form [here](#) (btw anyone is going to check it!). ⚠️ **SCAM ALERT!** ⚠️ Use **ONLY** the official channel linked above. Fake websites are circulating that mimic the official one and **fraudulently request payments**.
- EXTRA: Download the map of Sri Lanka to have it offline. It will be useful with the transfer to have all the info and when you need to talk with the van driver.

Important Information

- If you are from Argentina or other countries of South America it is quite possible that you will be forced to get the vaccine against the yellow fever --> https://www.immigration.gov.lk/pages_e.php?id=22
- **Dengue:** Dengue fever is endemic in Sri Lanka (and present in the Maldives too), but no WeRoad pax has ever been affected on our trips. Basic prevention is enough: use a high-protection mosquito repellent spray (reapply regularly, especially at dawn/dusk), cover arms and legs when possible in the evening, and use the mosquito nets/AC provided by the hotels. No specific vaccine or prophylaxis is required, just good behavioural habits.
- Talk to the co-driver at the beginning of the trip to clarify whether the group is interested or not in shopping stops etc... sometimes drivers can be pushy, so make sure that you set-up the right mood at the beginning of the trip.

Travel note

- **IMPORTANT:** We always try to work with the same local guides, but due to the high number of departures – especially in summer – this isn't always possible. That's why you shouldn't rely too heavily on the suggested timings and travel durations: **ALWAYS DOUBLE-CHECK ON GOOGLE!**
- **Internet:** You can buy a SIM card at the airport, but prices there are usually higher. It's better to purchase it **after passport control**, as it's much cheaper than the shop before

immigration (the best companies are **SLT Mobitel** and **Dialog**). I personally recommend **Dialog**.

- For some transfers you can use UBER or PICK ME (local app).

- **What to pack absolutely (no basic stuff!):**

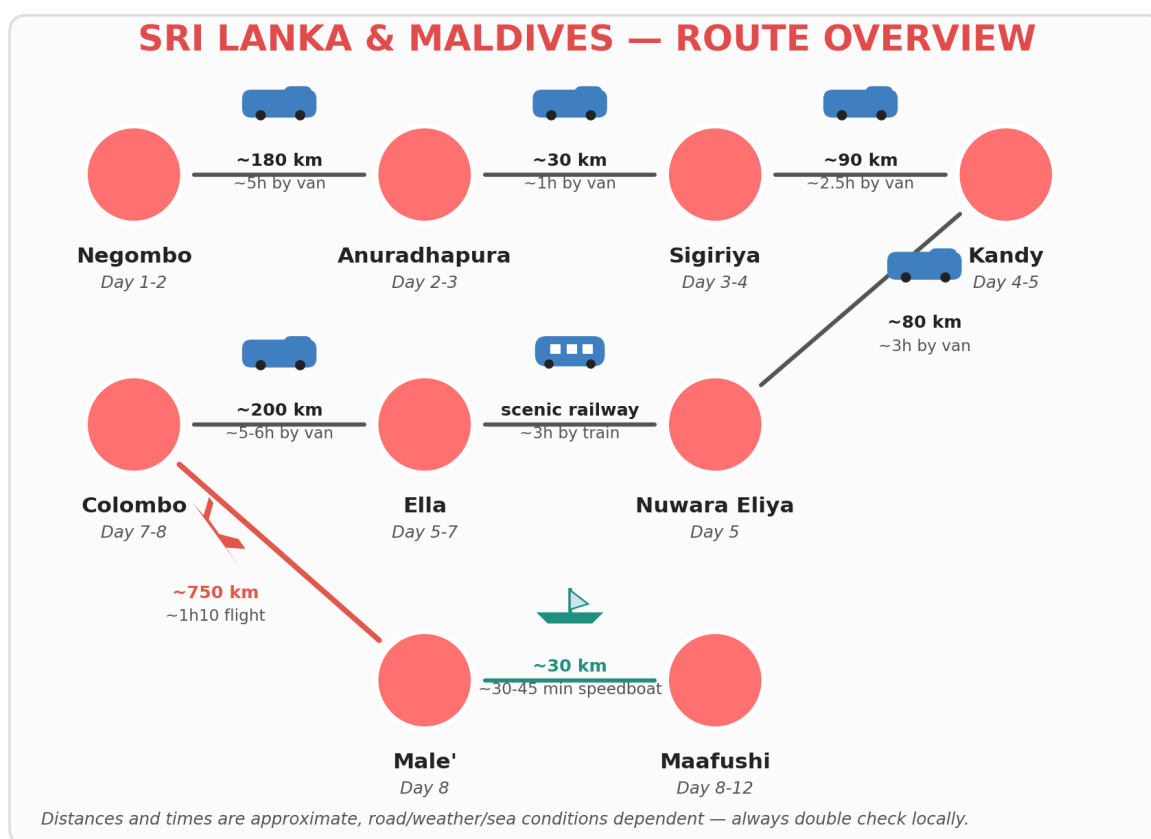
→ **Long trousers or a pareo:** To visit the temples, your clothing must cover your knees. This is mandatory. Sometimes you can buy a pareo near the temples, but it's easier if you already have something to cover yourself. You must also cover your shoulders.

→ **Socks for the temples:** You cannot walk inside the temples with shoes. The floor can be very hot, so wearing socks is recommended to protect your feet.

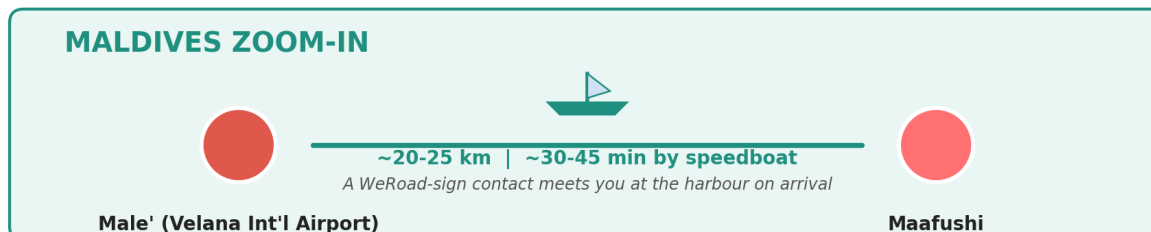
→ Power adapter type BS546 needed in some of the areas.

→ High protection mosquitos repellent (like Jungle or similar).

ITINERARY OVERVIEW



MALDIVES ZOOM-IN



	Where	Service	Meals included	Prebooked?	Prepaid?	Organized by
Day 1	Negombo	Overnight hotel	-	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 2	Negombo	Van with Transport with Eng speaking driver + co-driver	B	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	Anuradhapura	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 3	Anuradhapura	Van with Transport with Eng speaking driver + co-driver	B, L	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	Sigirya	Local lunch and Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 4	Sigirya	Van with English speaking driver	B	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	Kandy	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 5	Kandy	Van with English speaking driver	B	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	Nuwara Eliya	Tea plantation Visit + Train to Ella		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 6	Ella	Optional Activities	B	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	Ella	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 7	Ella	Van with English speaking driver and rafting	B	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	Colombo	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 8	Colombo	Van with English speaking driver	B	YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	colombo	Flight to Malè		YES	YES	TRAVEL PRODUCER OR DMC
	Colombo	Compulsory Tips for driver and co-drivers (min 15000 rupees each)		-	-	-
	malè	Transfer to Maafushi		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
	Maafushi	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 9	Maafushi	Optional activities	B	NO	NO	ALBA
	Maafushi	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA

	Where	Service	Meals included	Prebooked?	Prepaid?	Organized by
Day 10	Maafushi	Optional activities	B	NO	NO	ALBA
	Maafushi	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 11	Maafushi	Optional activities	B	NO	NO	ALBA
	Maafushi	Overnight hotel		YES	YES	WANDERLUST ASIA
Day 12	Maafushi	Check-out	B	-	-	-

DAY BY DAY SUMMARY

Day 1 – Negombo

You can get in contact with Wanderlust Asia (Mr. Anton) to set up a first briefing meeting at the first hotel lobby in Negombo.

Lunch, dinner, nights (*SUGGESTED*)

- [TUK TUK RESTAURANT](#) (WA – Restaurant manager 0094 778157070)
- [LORDS RESTAURANT](#) – perfect choice not so far from the hotel – martin@lordsrestaurant.net
- [SEA VIEW RESTAURANT](#): Ideal for small groups who want to keep costs low and enjoy a familiar, more local atmosphere.
- [ZEN CAFÉ](#) (LUNCH)
- [CHEF GRAB \(LUNCH\)](#) – close to the earl's Regent Hotel
- [RODEO PUB](#) (NIGHT)

Overnight at hotel (*INCLUDED*)

Day 2 – Anuradhapura

Van with English speaking driver (*INCLUDED*)

Transfer from Negombo Anuradhapura, it takes 5 hours by van. You can stop as many times as you want but try to limit it to 1-2. There are bars on the way to go to the toilet and get coffee.

Lunch, dinner and night (*SUGGESTED*)

- Lunch buffet restaurant (just ask to the co-driver – TLF)

Anuradhapura historical site (*SUGGESTED*)

It's suggested to arrange the visit of the site with a local guide (ask to your co-driver) – Price: around 6000/8000 rupees + tips. After Anuradhapura is highly recommended to [visit Mihintale](#)

Suggestion: ask to your co-driver to have the permission from the hotel to use the swimming pool at your arrival (until 8.30 pm); After such a day it's recommend to have dinner at the hotel (buffet) – TLF
Overnight at hotel (INCLUDED)

Day 3 – Minneriya NP and Sigiriya

Van with English speaking driver (INCLUDED)

Transfer from Anuradhapura to Minneriya – Pick-up around 7:30 a.m. (takes one hour). Make sure the hotel can arrange a breakfast early in the morning, and please remember that in Sri Lanka the service could be usually slow. **PLEASE CHECK WITH YOUR GUIDE THE TIMING FOR THE DEPARTURE: IN SUMMER I RECOMMEND YOU TO LEAVE EARLY TO AVOID THE HOTTEST HOURS!**

Activity (SUGGESTED)

- GAYAN SAFARI IN MINNERIYA PARK (OR OTHER PARKS DEPENDING ON THE SEASON): You can have a Safari today at Minneriya or other national parks in the area – just ask to the co-driver which parks should be better to visit according to the season. It's an Elephant Safari and depending on the season they can offer you to visit Minneriya National Park or something else. The Safari depends a lot on the season and where elephants are. Sometimes it is better to go to Hurulu Eco Safari if the elephants moved there from Minneriya.
- LOCAL LUNCH (INCLUDED): an amazing experience! You'll arrive at the starting point from which you'll be redirected on a very local transport (no spoiler) to get to the river and start a short journey on the water (another very local transport!). Finally you'll arrive to a local village when you can have your lunch. Use the tuk tuk to get back to the bus
- VISIT SIGIRIYA: Entrance fee 35 USD per person. It takes 1 hour and a half to climb (if going really slowly).
- AYURVERDIC CENTRE: if you need to relax, the driver can take you to a very nice Ayurvedic centre on the way back. He will ask you the day before if you want to do it because it has to be booked (we booked it for 19:00 and it was fine as time). Ask the driver to book it the day before.

Lunch, dinner and night (SUGGESTED)

- Highly suggested: [Rasta Rant Sigirya](#)

Day 4 – Road to kandy

- SUNRISE PIDURANGALA ROCK – HIGHLY RECOMMENDED: Check the time of the sunrise and leave the hotel at least 1h and a half before. 15 min by van from the hotel, half an hour max to climb, but the last part is really tough. Wear proper shoes (not flip flops). If somebody suffers from vertigo he/she can struggle a bit on this last part. Top view costs 1000 rupees, really worth it because you have the view of the mountain in front of Sigirya, one of the favorite photo spots.

Van with English speaking driver (round trip) (INCLUDED)

Activity (SUGGESTED)

- VISIT THE GOLD BUDDHA: just a photo stop;
- DAMBULLA CAVES:
- KANDY: Another 1.5–2 hour drive. On the way to Kandy, you can visit a **Spice Garden and have lunch there (highly recommended)**.
- The Tooth Ceremony: **a local guide is highly recommended**. officially starts at 6:30 PM, but the drumming begins at 6:15 PM. People usually start lining up from around 5:30 PM, especially to get a spot upstairs. The temple is very beautiful (entrance fee: 2,000 per person). The ceremony consists of queuing and briefly passing in front of the Tooth Relic for a few seconds. It is mainly a spiritual experience. You will likely need to stand in line for more than 30 minutes before the ceremony starts, so some participants may feel uncomfortable due to the crowds and close proximity to others.
- [don't worry if you arrive late in Kandy: you can also assist at the ceremony early in the morning, around 5.30 am](#) (definitely less crowded than the one in the afternoon).
- [During the kandy Esala Perahera the afternoon's Puja doesn't take place but you can assist to the one in the morning](#)

IMPORTANT: if you're traveling during July or August, you could have the chance to assist at the Kandy Esala Perahera. The [Kandy Esala Perahera](#) is one of the **most important and spectacular religious festivals in Sri Lanka**, held every year in **Kandy**, usually between **July and August**.

It is a **grand Buddhist procession** held in honor of the **Sacred Tooth Relic of Buddha**, which is housed in the **Temple of the Tooth** in Kandy. The Tooth Relic is considered a powerful symbol of authority and protection for the country.

The festival lasts **about 10 days** and builds up gradually:

- The first nights are smaller and more symbolic.
- Each night, the procession becomes **bigger, longer, and more elaborate**.
- The final nights are the most impressive.

The procession includes:

- **Dozens of richly decorated elephants**, one of which carries a **golden casket** representing the Tooth Relic (the actual relic does not leave the temple).
- **Traditional dancers** (fire dancers, whip dancers, Kandyan dancers).
- **Drummers and musicians** performing rhythmic beats.
- **Torch bearers and flag carriers**, creating a very dramatic atmosphere.

Practical info for visitors

- The processions take place **in the evening/night**.
- Streets are extremely crowded; people often wait **hours** to secure a good spot.
- Seating (balconies or stands) must be booked in advance.
- It's loud, busy, and intense—but also unforgettable.

Lunch, dinner and night (SUGGESTED)

- At the hotel or wherever you prefer

Overnight at hotel (INCLUDED)

Day 5 – From Kandy To Ella

Van with English speaking driver (INCLUDED)

Transfer from Kandy to Nuwara Eliya. It takes around 3/4h transfer. On the way, you will stop to visit the [Ambuluwawa Tower](#) (extra program) – just remember that it's not the best experience if you have vertigo!

Just comment it to your co-driver if you decide to go there and it will arrange the logistic (tuk tuk). Before that, if you want to try a very trash experience, ask to your co-driver to arrange a quick stop to a local shop to wear the traditional clothes (#WeLoveTrash).

Activity (SUGGESTED)

Tea plantation Visit

Panoramic train (INCLUDED)

Transfer by train from Nuwara Eliya station to Ella station (takes 3 hours). The time of departure depends on the day: some days it's possible to take the 10:00 am train, others you have to take the 12:45 pm train. The train can be very late on departure, even 1-2 hours. If you planned to do something in Ella in the afternoon (before the cooking class), be aware there are chances you'll have to skip it.

Transfer by van (with english speaking driver) to hotel (INCLUDED)

Short transfer from Ella station to the hotel in Ella.

Lunch, dinner and night

(SUGGESTED)

- **LUNCH:** ask your driver for something quick on the go. The sooner you get to Ella, the best.
- Dream café – good food and cheap – TLF
- **DINNER:** Ella is full of bars and restaurants for all tastes.
 - [Rocky Ella](#) – perfect for big groups – TLF – they often have live music or Karaoke
 - Roti Hut for cheap and abundant roti with chicken/cheese
 - Ratha Ella Sri Lanka, very typical
 - Café Chill: both Sri Lankan and international food, good drinks – TLF
 - One Love Ella

Overnight at hotel (INCLUDED)

Ella

Day 6 – Ella

Important information for the day:

- Regardless of where you are going to see the sunrise, bring at least a sweater with you because it may be windy/cold while waiting for the sun.
- Warn pax that the way is completely dark and there are a few stray dogs, but they are harmless.
- After the sunrise hike there's enough time to go back to the hotel for breakfast, so you don't need to ask for a packed one

- I recommend buying souvenirs at Ella because it is one of the places with the best deals.

Little Adam's Peak or Ella Rock (sunrise)

Little Adam's Peak is a very easy and short hike, like 30 min from the hotel (one way). The sun comes out from behind a mountain.

Ella Rock it's higher, so if you have an adventure-lover group you could do this for the sunrise and Little Adam's peak in the afternoon/sunset. It's like 1.5h/2h one way, ask your driver for help. Otherwise you can keep Little Adam's Peak in the morning and do Ella Rock later.

We did **Ella Rock** in the morning not for the sunrise, but around 8.00 am. It is a long route and the last stretch is complicated to climb, so if someone in your group has asthma problems or complications, it is best to be warned. Along the way there are water and coconut stands to rest. And when you get to the hill to see the viewpoint you have to pay 1000 rupees per person. In the low season you can pay 500 rupees, which is the price of a child.

Nine arches bridge

The train should pass on the bridge between 11.30 am - 12.00 pm, but check with your driver. Take your time to take pictures from the top and on the platform. Reaching the bridge is like a 20/30 minutes walk from the hotel.

Muditha driver tuktuk - 0711971070 whatsapp

In our case we went after lunch, the train was delayed for 4 hours and we were lucky to see it (it can happen).

"Flying Ravana Mega Zipline" (near Little Adam's peak)

+94574930000 -

<https://www.flyingravana.com/> - tickets@flyingravana.com

Hours 08:30-17:00 Last entry timing: 4:00 pm Lunch Break: 12.30 pm to 01.30 pm

9600 rupees

Short, but beautiful experience

Alternatively, near the Zipline there are **"Fly Swing"** - \$10 and **"Ravana Pool Club"** resort pool for happy hour.

Waterfalls and shopping

- Diyaluma falls, even if are a little bit far away (check day 3)
- Ravana waterfall (check day 3)
- [Secret waterfall](#). They're hidden in the forest and you can bathe there but the path it's not well maintained, so go only if you have a very nature-lover group. Our driver stopped by a little house and made us go down from there. It was very difficult because we were literally in the middle of the jungle. On the way back, we found the true path with stairs (but still, it's not well kept). Times: like 15/20 minutes to go down.
- Second Secret falls https://maps.app.goo.gl/EyvEPVoDqDTpQCRS9?g_st=ic Easy access, there is only one stairway in the jungle. Nice and there is the possibility to swim. Beware of monkeys!

Ella is full of shops but they're pretty expensive. Nevertheless, consider buying there because it will be more difficult to find places in the following days.

Lunch, dinner and night

(SUGGESTED)

- **LUNCH:** check day 5

- **DINNER and NIGHT:** Rocky Ella - [One love Ella](#)

Day 7 – Rafting and Road to Colombo

Van with English speaking driver (INCLUDED)

Transfer from Ella to Colombo

Activity: white water rafting (INCLUDED)

Experience in Kitulgala organized by the local partner (WanderlustAsia).

Overnight at hotel (INCLUDED)

Day 8 – FLIGHT TO MALDIVES

Van with English speaking driver (INCLUDED)

Transfer from Colombo to the airport.

MANDATORY tip your driver and local coordinator (the minimum is 5 euros pax for the local coordinator and 5 euros/pax for the driver) using the common fund.

Flight from Colombo to Male (INCLUDED)

The vouchers or tickets will be provided on spot by the DMC

Speedboat from to Male to Maafushi (INCLUDED)

A man with a Weroad sign we'll be waiting for you in Male

Overnight at hotel (INCLUDED) –

In the major part of the cases you will be hosted in one of the **Triton Hotel** (Triton Beach, Triton prestige or the Triton exotica). Triton can also organize the excursions. If you need assistance for excursions or general information please refer to the **hotel manager Malithi at +960 7629991**

MAAFUSHI

The island is quite small—you can walk around it in about 20 minutes and see it from one side to the other. The island is divided into three areas. One side hosts all the hotels and the bikini beach, also known as the tourist beach. The Maldives is a very strict Muslim country, where sunbathing in a bikini is only allowed on designated tourist beaches.

Another side of the island is the local beach, where residents enjoy the beach themselves. The third area is the prison, located at the far end of the island.

With building work taking over the island, it would be hard to holiday there without hearing the constant sound of it throughout the day. But this is the norm when it comes to most local islands at the moment.

Tourism has exploded on the island, raising concerns about whether the locals can keep up with it — let alone whether it can be properly regulated by the government. That said, the only busy area is usually the tourist beach

Positive points to highlight about staying in Maafushi:

- If you want to experience the Maldives as we know them—complete with a wide range of excursions comparable to those offered by resorts—Maafushi is an excellent choice. **Thanks to strong competition among operators, prices are generally very competitive and offer great value for money.**
- Maafushi truly feels like a holiday island. **You'll find plenty of restaurants** to choose from, **music along the streets**, water sports activities, and modern comforts such as Western-style cafés and even a gym. **Many other local islands lack these amenities, where dining options are often limited to your guesthouse** and, if you're lucky, a small local shop.
- Getting around the Maldives can be challenging, but **Maafushi stands out as one of the easiest and most affordable islands to reach from the airport.** After extensive research, it's clear that Maafushi offers the best combination of accessibility, convenience, and cost.

Recommended Excursions and Partner

This is a tricky point because there are many operators around, and the service is not always up to standard. Be cautious of super cheap deals you see on the streets or on signs – the service is often terrible, and the boats look like they're a thousand years old!

Make sure your pax get the message too: nothing in this world comes for free.

Excursions in the Maldives are not included in the travel package and are at the pax's own expense. Below you'll find some suggestions from partners we've already received positive feedback on, but it's the tour leader's responsibility to get informed about each excursion, discuss the options with the group, and decide which operator to go with.

You're absolutely free to choose operators outside this list – but only if you're 100% sure they're reliable.

- [Super recommended: baptism of the sea with the Dive Squad](#): 75 dollars – TLF – you can pay with the credit card
1. **Triton Hotel** – please refer to the Hotel Manager for prices and information;
 2. [Maldives Fellas](#) – Please refer to Giorgia Atripaldi for prices and information (+39 339 6351542) – she's a WeRoad TL living and working in the Maldives and She must be contacted at least 15 days before your arrival in the Maldives.
 - Prices & Excursions (updated July 2026)
 - Whaleshark: \$110 per person
 - Sharkbay: \$60 per person
 - Half day: \$30 per person
 - Fish Tank: \$70 per person
- All excursions include snorkeling equipment, fins, mask, towel, water bottle, lunch, and underwater photos & videos with GoPro.
- Leopard shark + dolphins + Thinadhoo: \$80 per person
 - Shipwreck + Keyodhoo: \$110 per person
 - Olhuveli resort day visit: \$130 per person (Entrance in all inclusive + transfer)
 - **Airport transfer:**
 - Small boat: \$225
 - Medium boat: \$350

- Big boat: \$400
- Gulhi go and back: \$200
- **Diving:**
- With certification: \$45
- Without certification: \$85
- Bonfire only: \$35 per person
- Bonfire with bbq dinner: \$45 per person

Note for Coordinators: TLF is always included, except for the resort entrance fee (entrance only; transfer with us is free) and diving if done by a small number of participants.

3. ShadowPalm: **very reliable and super professional operator in Maafushi, perfect for WE and DE groups!** This is the mail that I received from the manager, with the 2026 updated prices for WR groups:

Team of marine biologists and local guides; tours include snorkeling gear, lunch, refillable water and underwater photos. They can also organise a full day in Gulhi (packed lunch, umbrellas, beach towels included – no beach chairs available).

Updated rates (2026) received directly from the ShadowPalm manager:

Half day: \$30 per person
 Shark Bay: \$60 per person
 Whale Shark: \$100 per person
 Bonfire with BBQ dinner: \$35 per person
 Bonfire without dinner: \$250 per group
 Diving: \$75 without certification / \$45 with certification
 Resort day: \$125 per person

Private boat: the same per-person rates above apply as private boat rates for larger groups. Two private boat sizes are available: a 10-passenger and a 24-passenger capacity boat. For smaller groups, rates are reviewed case by case once the coordinator confirms the total number of guests. Boats are Gulf Craft-built with premium features (GPS, fish finder, drones, stabilizer) — hence the slightly higher price point.

Note for Coordinators: leaders (TL) are free of charge on all tours and services, confirmed for both small and bigger groups.

⚠ Gulhi full day trip and Resort day rates below are the last ones on file (unconfirmed against the 2026 update — please double check with ShadowPalm before publishing to pax):

10 passenger capacity boat – Gulhi full day (packed lunch, umbrellas, beach towels) - \$210 (private)

24 passenger capacity boat – Gulhi full day (packed lunch, umbrellas, beach towels) - \$360 (private)

We can only accept euros in cash, our euro rates are the same as our dollar rates.

Our contact details are:

Email: shadowpalm@maafushi.com

Whatsapp: +960 9960109

These rates are special rates and we trust you to keep it confidential. Happy to offer one coordinator free of charge for each group bigger than 8 travellers.

Thank you, let us know if you are interested to start the groups, and deliver unforgettable experiences.

[EXPLANATION AND DETAILS OF THE EXCURSIONS HERE](#)

4. **Alba: very reliable, Italian-speaking contact in Maafushi, can arrange everything for you.**

Contact: +39 340 864 7210 (WhatsApp)

Suggested excursions:

- Trip to Gulhi a/r with soft lunch included: 25 euros/pax TLF
- Ray and Nurse sharks snorkeling: full day with lunch included, 80 euros/pax TLF (+20 euros for the drone video)

Restaurants in Maafushi:

Moonlight Maafushi – TLF

Navio – very local

Mr Octopus

To drink something:

Caviar Café & Restaurant

Day 12– Maafushi

Check-out. No services booked for today.

Please note that the trip will end in Maafushi. As specified on the website, the return speedboat transfer from Maafushi to Male is not included and it's on the pax to decide at what time depart according to the flight schedule.

Please find here the departure schedule: <https://icomtours.com/>

You can easily book the speedboat when in Maafushi, at the hotel desk (I suggest you do it 3-4 days in advance) and you can pay with the credit card (or online at the link above).

There is also another ferry company available, more local but quite reliable; if the schedule of Icom doesn't fit your need, go and ask to [Maafushi tours](#), just in front of the jetty